



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Writing Spot: Live life to the fullest.



Learning Outcome

Describe detailed facts about events or actions in work and social contexts, in written or spoken situations

Ask your partner:

- Do you think you will be an active senior? Why or why not?
- What types of activities or sports would you want to do?

Can Do Statements

- I can write an article about sports.
- I can write about or report facts about events or actions.
- I can express true, untrue and possible events in the past.





Let's Explore!

Grandma **takes to the skies***!

* "To take to the skies" is a common expression that means to fly.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Centenarian Soars In Kilimanjaro

Turning 100 should have been considered remarkable for Marion Van Loon. However, this dedicated skydiver took a leap of faith on June 19th when she became the first person over 100 years old to parachute out of a plane above the clouded peaks of Africa's highest mountain.

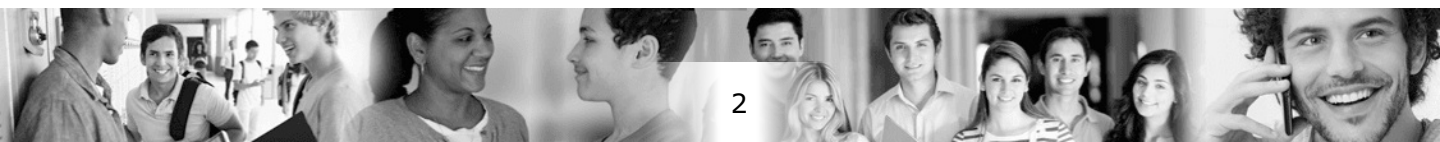
Marion Van Loon, from Norway, had to spend months preparing for the event. Firstly, her stamina and strength was increased by using a conditioning coach. Training included long walks with her grandchildren and weekly visits to the pool.

There were initial fears that the jump could have been delayed because of unpredictable weather.

The parachutist's plane must have flown only about 200 meters above the majestic mountain at sunrise when the doors were opened.

During the jump, oxygen masks were worn by Marion and her instructor. Otherwise, the air might have been too thin for them to breathe safely. They were in free fall for 35 seconds before their chutes opened. At that point, Marion was awestruck by the scenery as she glided towards the landing zone. A member of Van Loon's family explained to the crowd. "Granny is an inspiring woman," she said. The previous record of William Johansson, an 89-year-old veteran from Colorado, was shattered by this jump once Marion landed.

Marion was ecstatic with her jump. "My amazing jump should encourage older citizens to be more active. Don't be a couch potato. Get off the couch and get moving!" Being active runs in Marion's family. Her 80 year old son recently competed in the Masters Games as a sprinter while her granddaughter runs half-marathons. If you are a thrill seeker, itineraries such as this one can be organized by a number of agencies. The centenarian's jump was organized by Extreme Sports Africa and funding was provided by donations.





Let's Practice!

Tell us the sequence of events.

Instructions: Unscramble the words to find the mystery sentence. Write the sentences correctly.

1. her stamina / by / was increased / coach. / Firstly, / using a / conditioning
2. the jump / mask was / worn by / an oxygen / During / Marian.
3. landed. / The previous / shattered by / record of / once Marion / this jump / was / William Johansson
4. Sports Africa. / by Extreme / This centenarian's / organized / jump was /



Let's Practice!

Now, it's your turn to write an article about sports.

Instructions:

- *Imagine you have to write an article about sports. Your boss asks you to write an article about a sporting hero or event.*
- *Write a 100-150 word article on a sportsperson or event that took place.*
- *Write a title that is interesting and grabs the reader's attention.*
- *In your first two sentences, focus on the important information (who, what, when, where, why).*
- *Add words that show a sequence of events.*
- *Quote someone at the scene.*
- *Use the passive form in at least one sentence.*

Title: _____

Sports Article:





Extension Activity

Research sports articles online.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online and find articles on three different sports.
- Read each article and write down this information:
 - Title of article
 - Who wrote it?
 - What happened?
 - When did it happen?
 - Where did it happen?
 - Why did it happen?
- Then, choose one article and share the information with a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I research sports articles online.

☐ ☐

I complete a table about the elements of an article.

☐ ☐

I share the information from one article with a partner.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- centenarian** (noun): a person who is 100 years old or older
e.g. This centenarian's jump was organized by Extreme Sports Africa.
- free fall** (noun): the state or condition of falling through the air toward the ground
e.g. They were in free fall for 35 seconds before their chutes opened.
- stamina** (noun): great physical or mental strength that allows you to continue doing something for a long time
e.g. Her stamina and strength were increased through training.
- donation** (noun): something that you give in order to help a person or organization
e.g. Funding was provided by donations.
- oxygen mask** (noun): something you wear over your nose and mouth that provides oxygen
e.g. Oxygen masks were worn by Marion and her instructor.
- leap of faith** (expression): a risk
e.g. However, this dedicated skydiver took a leap of faith on June 19th.
- to shatter** (verb): to break suddenly and completely
e.g. Her jump shattered the previous record of William Johansson.
- veteran** (noun): someone who fought in a war as a soldier, sailor, etc.
e.g. William Johansson, an 89-year-old veteran from Colorado held the record.
- conditioning** (adjective): the process of becoming stronger and healthier by following a regular exercise program and diet
e.g. Her conditioning coach was very helpful.
- Masters Games** (noun): international sporting event for people over a certain age
e.g. Her 60-year-old son recently competed in the Masters Games as a sprinter.





Learning Points

Simple Past Passive to Report Events

You can use the **passive voice** when you want to report events that happened in the past in a general way.

Most of spoken English uses active speech. When you use an active sentence to report an event, the subject is the focus of the sentence.

Example:

- *Extreme Sports Africa (subject) organized this centenarian's jump (object).*

A **passive sentence** puts the emphasis on the object of the active sentence. When you use a **passive sentence** to report an event, the object of the active sentence now becomes the subject and focus of the passive sentence.

Example:

- *This centenarian's jump (subject) **was organized by** Extreme Sports Africa (object).*

You can use the **Simple Past passive** form to report events in an impersonal way. The subject is not specific, but general.

Example:

- ***It was reported that*** Marion Van Loon became the first person over 100 to parachute out of a plane.

You make the **passive form** of a verb by using tenses of the **be** verb followed by the **past participle**.

Examples:

- *Firstly, her stamina and strength were increased by using a conditioning coach.*
- *During the jump, oxygen masks were worn by Marion and her instructor.*
- *The previous record of William Johansson, an 89-year-old veteran from Colorado, was shattered by this jump once Marion landed.*
- *This centenarian's jump was organized by Extreme Sports Africa and funding was provided by donations.*





Learning Points

Passive of Modal Verbs in the Past

You use the **Simple Past passive** form of **Modal verbs** to put the emphasis on the receiver of the action.

As for other verbs, the **Simple Past passive** form of modal verbs puts the emphasis on the receiver of the action and not on the doer of the action.

Passive modal forms are often impersonal and do not require an object.

Example:

- *Sports shoes must be worn on the field.*
- *Baseball may be played on Tuesdays.*

The structure of **Simple Past passive** for modal verbs is:

subject+modal verb+have been+past participle of verb

You can use **Simple Past modal** verbs to convey certainty, possibility, or uncertainty about a past event or situation.

Passive	Meaning
<i>The air might have been too thin to breathe otherwise.</i>	possibility
<i>There were fears that the jump could have been delayed.</i>	possibility
<i>Turning 100 should have been considered a remarkable feat.</i>	strong likelihood
<i>Marion's 80-year-old son must have been blessed with her amazing genes.</i>	certainty

